

STAGE SIX • COMMUNICATION: SPEAKING, READING & WRITING

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Six sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 70 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Six • Communication: Speaking, Reading & Writing

OVERVIEW

Stage Six is the largest stage in the entire program: seventy FIRSTS across six sessions, one per section, matching the Manual's structure. Given the scale, this Session Plan works differently from smaller stages' plans: rather than a minute-by-minute agenda for every individual FIRST, each session below lists its FIRSTS in a compact reference table, with pre-work and facilitator notes specific to that session.

Plan on roughly 3-5 minutes of framing per FIRST (using the Facilitator Guide's talking points) plus independent worksheet time, which the Templates workbook (Parts 1 and 2) breaks into individual pages. A full session covering 8-17 FIRSTS will typically run 2.5 to 4 hours depending on section size — several sessions in this stage genuinely warrant splitting across two sittings.

Given the sheer number of FIRSTS, consider NOT running every single one as a live group exercise. A reasonable approach: pick 3-4 FIRSTS per session for genuine live discussion and group work (see the companion Group Versions of Key Exercises document), and let participants complete the remainder independently using the Templates workbook, reviewing as a group only briefly.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
Session 1	Written Communication — 17 FIRSTS	~3.5-4 hrs (or split into 2)
Session 2	Verbal & Presentation Skills — 15 FIRSTS	~3.5-4 hrs (or split into 2)
Session 3	Listening, Reading & Comprehension — 8 FIRSTS	~2-2.5 hrs
Session 4	Interpersonal & Networking Communication — 13 FIRSTS	~3-3.5 hrs
Session 5	Feedback, Reflection & Self-Assessment — 9 FIRSTS	~2.5-3 hrs
Session 6	Communication Systems & Tools — 8 FIRSTS	~2-2.5 hrs

SESSION 1

Written Communication

17 FIRSTS, approximately 3.5–4 hours total. Given the volume in this stage, treat each FIRST as a brief, focused block rather than an extended discussion — the Facilitator Guide's talking points are meant to be used in 3–5 minutes of framing per FIRST, not a full mini-lecture.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring 5–10 of their own recent sent emails (for I39's audit) and a real report or document draft if they have one (for I8, I9).

FIRSTS IN THIS SESSION

Time	Segment	Format
I1	Professional Email Sent	15 min
I2	Meeting Agenda Prepared	15 min
I8	Written Report Drafted	20 min
I9	Report Edited for Clarity	15 min
I10	Technical Document Created	20 min
I15	Persuasive Email Sent	20 min
I18	Business Proposal Drafted	25 min
I19	Meeting Minutes Documented	15 min
I24	Summary Email Sent After Meeting	10 min
I33	Follow-Up Email After Networking	15 min
I38	Written Technical Summary	20 min
I39	Email Etiquette Audit	15 min
I44	Written Proposal Feedback	15 min
I46	Email to Recruiter	15 min
I50	Collaborative Document Editing	15 min
I62	Written Executive Summary	20 min
I65	Email Draft Templates Library	20 min

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This is the largest single session in the stage. Strongly consider splitting it across two sittings: I1–I19 (the individual-message skills) as one session, I24–I65 (the more advanced/systemic ones) as a second.
- I8 and I9 (drafting and editing) work best with real time between them — don't schedule them back to back if you can help it; assign I8 as pre-work and do I9 live instead.

SESSION 2

Verbal & Presentation Skills

15 FIRSTS, approximately 3.5–4 hours total. Given the volume in this stage, treat each FIRST as a brief, focused block rather than an extended discussion — the Facilitator Guide's talking points are meant to be used in 3–5 minutes of framing per FIRST, not a full mini-lecture.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring their phones for multiple recording exercises (I5, I21), and to have their FIRST 11 elevator pitch from prior work accessible for I57's refinement.

FIRSTS IN THIS SESSION

Time	Segment	Format
I3	Presentation Script Written	20 min
I4	Presentation Delivered	20 min
I5	Public Speaking Recording	20 min
I11	Elevator Pitch Practiced	15 min
I20	Storytelling Exercise	20 min
I21	Voice Recording Review	15 min
I22	Presentation Slide Deck Created	20 min
I23	Debate Participation	25 min
I28	Group Presentation Coordinated	20 min
I29	Impromptu Speaking Drill	15 min
I31	Persuasive Presentation	20 min
I51	Presentation to Non-Expert Audience	20 min
I57	Elevator Pitch Refinement	15 min
I63	Peer Learning Circle Presentation	20 min
I66	Read-Aloud Exercise	10 min

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This session is recording- and speaking-heavy; expect real discomfort, especially around I5 and I21. Normalize it explicitly at the start.
- I23 (Debate) and I28 (Group Presentation) both need groups of at least 3–4 — plan your room or breakout structure with this in mind.
- Like Session 1, consider splitting: I3–I29 as one sitting, I31–I66 as a second, if your cohort's energy flags.

SESSION 3

Listening, Reading & Comprehension

8 FIRSTS, approximately 2–2.5 hours total. Given the volume in this stage, treat each FIRST as a brief, focused block rather than an extended discussion — the Facilitator Guide's talking points are meant to be used in 3–5 minutes of framing per FIRST, not a full mini-lecture.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring a genuinely challenging piece of reading from their field (for I27), and to have a podcast or video episode ready to reference (for I26).

FIRSTS IN THIS SESSION

Time	Segment	Format
I6	Active Listening Drill	15 min
I14	Reading Summary Exercise	15 min
I26	Podcast or Video Commentary	15 min
I27	Reading Comprehension Challenge	20 min
I35	Reading List for Career Growth	15 min
I47	Reflective Reading Journal	15 min
I49	Reading Speed & Comprehension Drill	15 min
I55	Listening and Summarization Exercise	15 min

FACILITATOR NOTES

- The shortest session in the stage — a good one to run as a single sitting without splitting.
- I6 (Active Listening) pairs well as a live paired exercise; most of the rest work fine as independent worksheet time with a brief share-out.

SESSION 4

Interpersonal & Networking Communication

13 FIRSTS, approximately 3–3.5 hours total. Given the volume in this stage, treat each FIRST as a brief, focused block rather than an extended discussion — the Facilitator Guide's talking points are meant to be used in 3–5 minutes of framing per FIRST, not a full mini-lecture.

PRE-WORK

- No special materials needed, though I41 (Professional Chat with Senior) works best if participants have identified a real senior contact to reach out to before or shortly after this session.

FIRSTS IN THIS SESSION

Time	Segment	Format
I12	Networking Conversation	15 min
I13	Mock Interview	25 min
I16	Discussion Facilitation	20 min
I17	Cross-Cultural Communication Exercise	20 min
I32	Professional Networking Introduction	15 min
I37	Online Discussion Participation	15 min
I41	Professional Chat with Senior	20 min
I42	Conflict Resolution Conversation	20 min
I45	Meeting Facilitation in Class/Group	20 min
I48	Online Course Discussion Participation	15 min
I53	Professional Social Media Commenting	10 min
I64	Scenario-Based Communication Drill	20 min
I69	Public Forum Participation	15 min

FACILITATOR NOTES

- I13 (Mock Interview) and I42 (Conflict Resolution) both benefit from paired role-play — pair people deliberately rather than leaving it to chance.
- I41 and I69 involve real people or settings outside the session (a senior professional, a public forum) — frame these as launched today, followed up on independently.

SESSION 5

Feedback, Reflection & Self-Assessment

9 FIRSTS, approximately 2.5–3 hours total. Given the volume in this stage, treat each FIRST as a brief, focused block rather than an extended discussion — the Facilitator Guide's talking points are meant to be used in 3–5 minutes of framing per FIRST, not a full mini-lecture.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one real mentor or trusted colleague they could reach out to for I67 before this session, so the actual conversation can happen soon after.

FIRSTS IN THIS SESSION

Time	Segment	Format
I7	Feedback Response	15 min
I25	Professional Feedback Given	15 min
I30	Written Reflection on Learning	15 min
I36	Communication Self-Assessment	20 min
I40	Reflection on Public Speaking Anxiety	15 min
I54	Peer Review Feedback	20 min
I60	Reflective Speaking Log	10 min
I67	Communication Reflection with Mentor	20 min
I70	Reflection on Persuasion Techniques	15 min

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This session is more introspective than the others — build in genuine quiet reflection time rather than rushing through worksheets.
- I67 requires a real conversation outside the session; frame it as launched today rather than completed live.

SESSION 6

Communication Systems & Tools

8 FIRSTS, approximately 2–2.5 hours total. Given the volume in this stage, treat each FIRST as a brief, focused block rather than an extended discussion — the Facilitator Guide's talking points are meant to be used in 3–5 minutes of framing per FIRST, not a full mini-lecture.

PRE-WORK

- No special materials required. This session works well as the stage's closing session since I34 and I68 both involve setting forward-looking goals.

FIRSTS IN THIS SESSION

Time	Segment	Format
I34	Documented Communication Goals	15 min
I43	Visual Communication Exercise	20 min
I52	Active Note-Taking System	15 min
I56	Communication Flow Mapping	20 min
I58	Storyboard Creation	20 min
I59	Communication Metrics Tracking	15 min
I61	Interview Question Bank Created	20 min
I68	Communication Challenge Goal	10 min

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This closing session is a natural moment to look back across the entire stage — consider opening with a brief round of “what's one communication habit that's already changed since Session 1?” before diving in.
- This is a natural moment to preview Stage Seven (Hard Skills), which builds directly on the systems and tools habits developed here.